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Ambassador Overview – Tidy Butt

Our Mission

“We educate, empower, and support individuals to better understand their mental health and wellbeing. Through open, honest conversations and a strong sense of community, we help people build confidence, find connection, and develop the tools to face life’s challenges. We believe good mental health is for everyone.”

Does this mission resonate with you? Have you experienced these kinds of challenges, either directly or through someone close to you? Do you believe that conversations, community, and connection can make a real difference in someone’s life?

Being an ambassador often starts with understanding why this matters to you.

So, you want to be an ambassador

Shwmae, and thank you for being here.

Choosing to become an ambassador is not just about volunteering your time. It is choosing to stand alongside people, to listen, to support, to encourage, and sometimes simply to be present when someone needs another human being nearby. Being an ambassador is about connection, community, and helping people take small steps forward when things feel difficult, overwhelming, or uncertain.

You are not expected to be a counsellor, therapist, social worker, or rescuer. You are a supportive person within a community who helps people feel welcome, included, and not alone.

This document is intended to give you a high-level overview of what being an ambassador means, what you might do, and some important things to understand before getting started.

What is TidyButt?

TidyButt is a community-focused organisation that aims to support people through connection, activity, conversation, and community engagement. The focus is on helping people take positive steps, however small, towards improved wellbeing, confidence, and social connection.

Many people who engage with TidyButt may be experiencing:

- Loneliness or isolation
- Anxiety or low mood
- Loss of confidence
- Life changes or difficult circumstances
- Mental health challenges
- Financial or socio-economic pressures
- Periods of crisis

TidyButt is not a clinical service. It is a community, a support network, and a place where people can find connection, structure, encouragement, and opportunities to move forward.

Ambassadors are a key part of making this possible.

What does it mean to be an ambassador?

Being a TidyButt volunteer or ambassador isn't just about what you do; it's about the impact you create. Volunteers bring energy, passion, and a shared commitment to making mental health support more accessible.

At the heart of this are a few simple ideas:

- **Community focused** – Creating safe spaces for open conversations and support.
- **Passionate about change** – Helping break the stigma around mental health and supporting real change through commitment and consistency.
- **Supportive and inclusive** – Whether welcoming people at events or providing a listening ear, helping people feel valued and heard.
- **Ready to grow and learn** – Volunteering is also an opportunity for personal growth, learning new skills, meeting like-minded people, and making a difference.

These are not strict requirements. They are more like the mindset and values that help someone be a good ambassador.

Being an ambassador means you represent the values, behaviour, and culture of TidyButt when you are interacting with the public, participants, partners, and other volunteers.

At its core, being an ambassador means:

- Being welcoming
- Being kind
- Being reliable
- Being calm
- Being respectful
- Being inclusive
- Being supportive without trying to “fix” people
- Helping people feel safe and comfortable
- Helping people access activities, support, and community

You are not there to solve everyone's problems. You are there to help people feel that they are not facing things alone.

Possible ambassador roles

Ambassadors may be involved in different types of activities depending on their interests, confidence, and availability. These roles may overlap, and people may do more than one.

Community Activity Ambassador

- Supporting community activities and sessions
- Welcoming new people
- Helping people feel comfortable in groups
- Encouraging participation
- Helping with basic organisation on the day

Outreach or Awareness Ambassador

- Speaking to community groups
- Sharing information about TidyButt
- Attending events or community days
- Helping people understand what support is available

Events and Support Ambassador

- Helping run events
- Supporting fundraising activities
- Helping with logistics and organisation
- Supporting participants during events

Admin or Coordination Support

- Helping with communication
- Supporting coordination of activities
- Helping organise sessions or resources
- Supporting behind-the-scenes work

Not everyone has to do everything. People can contribute in ways that suit their skills, confidence, and personal situation.

How ambassadors make a difference

Ambassadors make a difference in ways that are often small but very important.

Examples include:

- Talking to someone who has not spoken to anyone all week
- Helping someone attend their first group or activity
- Listening to someone who is having a difficult time
- Encouraging someone who lacks confidence
- Helping someone feel part of a community
- Helping events run smoothly so people can attend safely
- Being a familiar, friendly face
- Helping someone take their first small step forward

You may not always see the impact you have, but small actions can make a very big difference to someone else's life.

Important considerations – Supporting people with mental health challenges

Some of the people you meet may be going through very difficult periods in their lives. You may hear difficult stories, see people in distress, or meet people in crisis.

It is important to understand a few key principles.

You are not a rescuer.

There is a concept sometimes called the “Rescue Triangle” (or Drama Triangle), which includes:

- The Rescuer
- The Victim
- The Persecutor

As an ambassador, you must avoid becoming the rescuer. Trying to “save” people, take responsibility for their lives, or solve their problems can be harmful to them and to you.

Your role is to:

- Listen

- Support
- Signpost
- Encourage
- Stay calm
- Maintain boundaries

Not to fix, rescue, or take responsibility for someone else's life.

Hearing difficult or traumatic stories

You may hear about:

- Bereavement
- Abuse
- Addiction
- Suicide attempts
- Self-harm
- Homelessness
- Financial crisis
- Relationship breakdown

This can be emotionally difficult. It is important that:

- You do not carry this alone
- You speak to the TidyButt team if something is worrying you
- You understand your limits
- You take breaks when needed
- You look after your own wellbeing

This is sometimes called **vicarious trauma** or **secondary trauma** – hearing other people's trauma can affect you too.

Looking after yourself is not selfish. It is necessary.

If someone is in crisis

Ambassadors are not expected to manage crisis situations alone.

If someone:

- Talks about suicide
- Talks about self-harm
- Is in immediate distress
- Appears to be in danger

You should follow the TidyButt escalation or safeguarding process and contact the appropriate person or emergency services if necessary. You will be given guidance on this separately.

Your role is to stay calm, stay with the person if safe to do so, and contact the appropriate support.

Boundaries and looking after yourself

To be a good ambassador, you must also look after yourself.

Important boundaries include:

- You are allowed to say no
- You are allowed to take breaks
- You are not available 24/7
- You should not give out personal contact details unless agreed
- You should not promise things you cannot deliver
- You should not take responsibility for someone else's safety alone
- You should ask for help when you need it

A burnt-out ambassador cannot help anyone. A supported ambassador can help many people.

The culture – Community, not hierarchy

TidyButt is not about hierarchy and titles. It is about people working together, supporting each other, and building something that helps others.

We want ambassadors to feel:

- Part of a team
- Supported
- Trusted
- Comfortable asking questions
- Comfortable saying when something is difficult
- Proud of what they are part of



This is a community and a tribe effort. We support each other, learn from each other, and build something together that is bigger than any one person.

Thank you

Thank you for taking the time to read this and to consider becoming an ambassador.

If this still sings to you, and you feel you have the time, the energy, and the capacity to support others, we would love to talk to you more about becoming part of this.

Even small actions can change someone's day, someone's week, or sometimes someone's life.

Diolch yn fawr.

We are glad you are here.